



Birla Institute of Technology & Science, Pilani

Pilani | Dubai | Goa | Hyderabad

ACADEMIC— UNDER GRADUATE STUDIES DIVISION

First Semester 2026-27

Course Handout Part II

Date: 1 August 2026

In addition to part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the Timetable), this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course Number : GSF 331

Course Title : TECHNIQUES IN SOCIAL RESEARCH

Instructor-in-charge : Dr. Tanu Shukla (Tanus@pilani.bits-pilani.ac.in, 6168- H.)

[Team of Instructors] : [] (email, chamber no.)

- 1. Course description:** Introduction to social research: nature, purpose, relevance, dimensions, and the research process. Quantitative, qualitative, mixed methods, and triangulation. Social theory, ideology, positivist, interpretivist, critical, feminist, and postmodern perspectives. Research ethics and research design. Measurement, reliability, validity, scales, and sampling. Experimental, survey, field, historical-comparative, and nonreactive research methods. Data collection techniques, questionnaire design, interviewing, content analysis, and secondary data analysis. Quantitative and qualitative data analysis, coding, concept formation, inferential statistics, and report writing. Research analytics and software applications: statistical analysis using SPSS and Jamovi; qualitative coding and thematic analysis using NVivo; bibliometric, scientometric, and science mapping using Graphica (e.g., knowledge network visualization and research analytics).
- 2. Scope and Objective of the Course:** This course seeks to provide knowledge and skills relevant for conducting social science research. It will cover the entire research process from problem formulation, interpretation of data (both qualitative and quantitative) to evaluation of research study. The course will also address fundamental social science issues, reasoning and approaches that govern certain methodologies. This course would help students in acquiring skills to undertake social research studies based on primary and/or secondary data.
- 3. Course learning outcomes:**
CLO1: Explain the philosophical foundations, paradigms, and methodological approaches of social research, and distinguish between qualitative, quantitative, and mixed-methods research designs.

CLO2: Design ethically sound social research studies by formulating research problems, conducting literature reviews, selecting appropriate research designs, sampling strategies, and data collection methods.

CLO3: Apply principles of measurement, reliability, validity, scale development, and sampling to develop rigorous research instruments for social science investigations.

CLO4: Analyze quantitative and qualitative data using appropriate statistical and qualitative analysis techniques, including the use of software such as SPSS, Jamovi, and NVivo.

CLO5: Evaluate and interpret findings from diverse research methodologies, including experimental, survey, field, historical-comparative, content analysis, and secondary data research, to draw evidence-based conclusions.

CLO6: Prepare and communicate research reports that demonstrate ethical research practices, critical interpretation of findings, and effective use of research analytics and visualization tools for scholarly dissemination.

4. Text books and references:

TB1. Neuman, W. Lawrence, Social Research Methods, Pearson Education, 7th ed., 2010

RB1. Naresh K. Malhotra, Satyabhushan Dash; Marketing Research: An Applied Orientation, 6/e; Pearson, 2010.

RB2. K. N. Krishnaswamy, AppalyerSivakumar, M. Mathirajan; Management Research Methodology, Pearson, 2009.

RB3. Joseph F. Hair, Bill Black, Barry Babin; Multivariate Data Analysis, 7/e; Pearson, 2010.

5. Course Format & Weekly Workflow

Wk no.	Module no.	Description	Ref.	Learning Outcome
1.	1	Introduction to social research Overview of course How does science work? Introduction to social research. Need to conduct social research	T1-C1	CLO1
1.	2	Research: Quantitative Vs. Qualitative Quantitative social research. Qualitative social research Steps of the research process.	T1-C1	CLO1
1.	3.	Need for social research What is the need to conduct social research? Relevance of it in today's information age	T1-C1	CLO1

2.	4.	Dimensions of Research Dimensions of Research. The time dimension in research.	T1-C2	CLO1
2.	5.	Purpose of Research The purpose of research. Audience for research Use of research.	T1-C2	CLO1
2.	6.	Data Collection Introduction to data collection Data collection techniques.	T1-C2	CLO1
3.	7.	Theory & Research Social theory versus ideology. Aspects of theory	T1-C3	CLO1
3.	8.	The Meanings of Methodology Three approaches to methodology Positivist social science. Interpretative social science. Critical social science.	T1-C4	CLO1
3.	9.	Postmodern research What is postmodern research? Feminist and postmodern research	T1-C4	CLO1
4.	10.	The Literature Review Introduction The process of literature review	T1-C5	CLO2
4.	11.	Conducting literature review How to conduct literature review? Ethical concerns	T1-C5	CLO2, CLO6
4-5	12-14	Presentations	-	CLO2
5	15.	Research Designs Introduction to research design Triangulation. Types of research designs.	T1-C6	CLO2
6	16.	Qualitative and Quantitative designs Qualitative and quantitative orientations toward research. Qualitative design issues. Quantitative design issues.	T1-C6	CLO2
6	17.	Measurements in research Why Measure? Qualitative and quantitative measurement. Parts of the measurement process.	T1-C7	CLO3

6	18.	Quantitative/Qualitative Measures Reliability and validity. A guide to quantitative measurement. Index construction. What are Scales? How to use them	T1-C7	CLO3
7	19.	Sampling Methods Introduction to sampling Need for sampling Various sampling methods	T1-C8	CLO2, CLO3
7	20.	Quantitative sampling Probability sampling. Probability sampling methods Examples	T1-C8	CLO2, CLO3
7	21.	Qualitative Nonprobability sampling methods & Examples	T1-C8	CLO2, CLO3
8	22.	Experimental Research Random assignment Experimental design logic.	T1-C9	CLO3, CLO5
8	23.	Validity of experimental research Internal validity External validity Practical considerations.	T1-C9	CLO3, CLO5
8	24.	Outcomes of experimental research Results of experimental research Making comparisons A word on ethics.	T1-C9	CLO3, CLO5
9	25.	Survey Research Introduction to survey research The logic of survey research.	T1-C10	CLO3, CLO5
9	26.	Survey Research: Types Constructing a questionnaire Types of surveys.	T1-C10	CLO3, CLO5
9	27.	Survey Research: Pros and Cons Advantages and disadvantages Interviewing Computer-assisted pilot-testing and Web surveys Ethics of survey.	T1-C10	CLO3, CLO5
10	28-30	Presentations	-	-

11	31.	Nonreactive Research What is nonreactive research? Nonreactive measurement Content analysis	T1-C11	CLO4, CLO5
11	32.	Secondary Analysis Existing statistics/documents secondary analysis Issues of inference Theory testing.	T1-C11	CLO4, CLO5
11	33.	Quantitative Data Analysis Dealing with data. Analysis and results for one variable.	T1-C12	CLO4, CLO5
12	34.	QDA: Two and more variables Analysis and results for two variables More than two variables.	T1-C12	CLO4, CLO5
12	35.	QDA: Making Inferences What is inferential statistics? How to make inferences?	T1-C12	CLO4, CLO5
12	36.	Field Research The logic of field research Choosing a site and gaining access Relations in the field Observing in the field.	T1-C13	CLO4, CLO5
13	37.	Field Research: Implementation Collecting data in the field The field research interview. Leaving the field. Ethical dilemmas of field research.	T1-C13	CLO4, CLO5
13	38.	Historical-Comparative Research Steps in a Historical-Comparative research project. Data and evidence in historical context.	T1-C14	CLO4, CLO5
13	39.	Analysis of Qualitative Data Comparing methods of data analysis Coding and concept formation Analytic strategies for qualitative data	T1-C14	CLO4, CLO5
14	40.	Qualitative Data Tools for qualitative data Examples	T1-C15	CLO4, CLO5
14	41.	Writing the Research Report and the Politics of Social Research The research report writing The politics of social research Objectivity and Value.	T1-C16	CLO6

14	42.	Conclusion Summary of the course Conclusion	T1-All	CLO6
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6. Evaluation Scheme:

(Given below are suggestions for possible kinds of evaluation components)

Component	Weightage	Duration	Date and time	Comments
Assignment 1	15%	-	TBA	TBA
Mid-Semester Test	30%	90 mins	As announced	Closed book
Assignment 2	15%	-	TBA	TBA
Comprehensive	45%	180 min	As announced	Closed book

7. **Criterion for NC:** 20% of the average of the top three performers or 30% of the median, whichever is lower.
8. **Attendance Policy:** Each student is expected to attend all classes and participate in all evaluation components.
9. **Chamber consultation hours:** TBA
10. **Makeup Policy:** Makeup will be given only for genuine cases (accompanied by proof) for the Mid-semester or comprehensive exam only.

Instructor-in-charge: Prof. Tanu Sukla

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